mind the role of Mahatma Gandhi. What is most important in the long run is not what others do, but what the people of the Indian subcontinent themselves do. Before there can be calls for atonement elsewhere, there must first be atonement amongst the people of the subcontinent to include those who collaborated in the injustices wreaked upon the Indian people by the Raj. Bhagat Singh must first be rehabilitated in the minds and hearts of the people where it most matters. The reason for this is quite simply that before one can call upon others to honour their heroes, they must first be honoured at home. We must avoid ethnonationalist accounts of our histories quite simply because they are not true. Cheap gimmickry is not a substitute for real societal change. No wonder Justice Markandey Katju has said that current Indian policies and issues surrounding events like Yoga Day, movements like Swatchh Bharat Abhiyan and controversial debates regarding Ram Mandir and cow protection are not the ideal representations of the India that Bhagat Singh stood for.[4] In the land of the sacred cow, India's pluralist identities stand in question today. Its liberal democracy, its secularism, its rush to globalization and even its economic growth have been abandoned in the ruthless pursuit of an ideology of homogenized nationalism that has led to obsessive self-harm. Professor David Edgerton has referred to 'the racialised nature of the imperial project' in Britain with which it has yet to come to terms. If this is so, then India has had a 'casteist' political and religiously discriminatory project which is still not altogether recognized. As Edgerton says that in Britain 'all our national history needs rethinking',[5] so in India too this is no less true.

The countries of the Indian subcontinent were born out of a frenzied bout of ethnic bloodletting. Instead of coming together as one in a violent revolutionary struggle against imperial rule they used violence against each other at precisely the moment of their liberation from foreign rule. The violence of Partition has still not been put to bed. Theirs was not an immaculate conception but a benighted one. It paved the way for the birth of two countries where previously there was one. The distinguishing hallmark was religion. Religion it was that was the reason for the savage and merciless killing of one neighbour by the other. The violence of